

Dear Bowdoin Admissions Committee,

Thank you for taking the time to review my application and for the opportunity to be reconsidered in Regular Decision. I am deeply grateful for your continued consideration, and I would like to share several meaningful updates from my gap year. I also wish to reaffirm that Bowdoin College remains my first-choice college.

Since submitting my application, I have intentionally used my gap year to gain real-world experience at the intersection of technology, public service, and community impact, values that to my belief match with Bowdoin's commitment to educating students for the common good.

I recently completed a professional internship at the Rwanda Information Society Authority (RISA), an institution mandated to digitize Rwandan society through the effective use of information and communication technologies and innovation. During this internship, I collaborated on the design and successful launch of a Project Management System for the Ministry of Youth and Arts, a platform now actively supporting project coordination and operations across youth centers in the country. This experience challenged me to apply my coding skills in a real-market environment while learning how thoughtful technology can improve service delivery.

Alongside my professional growth, I continued investing deeply in the **SheCan Initiative**, a community I discussed in my personal essay and one that remains central to my values. In December, I was happy to celebrate Christmas with SheCan's second intake of girls, and this experience truly went beyond my expectations. We shared a meal and had so much fun and I am very grateful for my friends and family who all helped me reach my goal, providing both emotional and financial support. Our committee was able to raise 800,000frws that helped in everything we had to do that also included awarding top performers who were able to make good use of the skills and came up with very exciting games and projects. Being part of SheCan continues to reinforce my commitment to creating spaces where girls are empowered to see themselves as innovators, leaders, and change-makers.

Most recently, I was selected for a professional internship at the Rwanda Civil Aviation Authority, where I have begun a six-month contract in a highly regulated and mission-critical

environment focused on developing industry-level technical, analytical, and ethical skills. As I start this journey, I am eager to deepen my practical skills, learn from experienced professionals, and take on increasing responsibility—while also quietly celebrating the milestone of receiving my very first paycheck by the end of this month.

Thank you very much for considering this update and for your time throughout the admissions process. I would be honored to join the Bowdoin College Class of 2030.

Sincerely,

Numwali Lydia